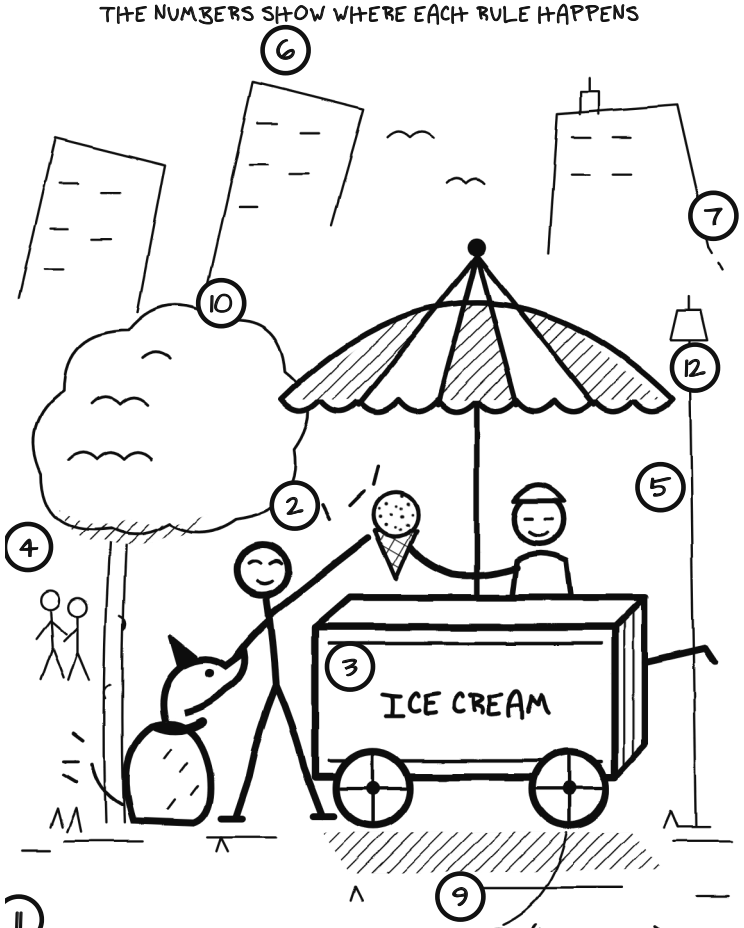
COO?

DA RULES

12 RULES FOR DRAWING OUT IN THE WORLD!

OF URBAN SKETCHING

THE NUMBERS SHOW WHERE EACH RULE HAPPENS



(1) SIT STILL LONG ENOUGH TO OBSERVE.

WATCH FOR 2 WHOLE MINUTES BEFORE YOUR FIRST LINE.

(2) LOOK FOR A "STORY MOMENT."

WHAT'S HAPPENING? THAT'S YOUR SUBJECT.

(3) START W/ LARGE SHAPES! NO DETAIL.

STORY MOMENT FIRST: **BIG**, IN THE MIDDLE. THEN BUILD OUT.

(4) DRAW PEOPLE AS GESTURES, NOT PORTRAITS.

BEAN BODY, STICK LIMBS. SHOW WHAT THEY'RE **DOING**.

(5) USE LINE WEIGHT TO FAKE DEPTH.

CLOSE = THICK + DARK.
FAR = THIN + LIGHT.

(6) BREAK PERSPECTIVE RULES

(STRATEGICALLY!) LEAN IT OR BEND IT IF IT TELLS THE STORY.

(7) LEAVE STUFF OUT.

NOT EVERY BRICK OR LEAF. LET THE EDGES FADE AWAY.

(8) DON'T ERASE!

PEN FROM LINE ONE. NO PENCIL = NOTHING TO ERASE.

(9) TREAT MISTAKES LIKE THEY BELONG.

WRONG LINE? DRAW THE RIGHT ONE NEXT TO IT.

OOPS (KEPT IT)

(10) EMBRACE SPEED.

FAST LINES LOOK ALIVE. PEOPLE MOVE, SO **YOU** MOVE.

(11) ADD NOTES OR TINY TEXT.

THE TIME, THE PLACE, WHAT YOU HEARD.

SAT · 10:42 AM
BAND PLAYING SOMEWHERE
SMELLS LIKE CHURROS

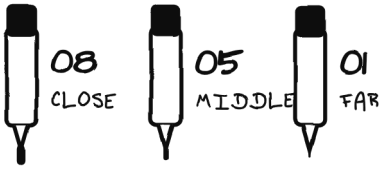
(12) LIMITED COLOR POPS.

INK FIRST. THEN 2-3 COLORS, ONLY WHERE IT MATTERS.

YOUR KIT:



NO PENCIL!



INK, WAIT, PAINT. MICRONS ARE WATERPROOF ONCE THEY DRY. GIVE THE INK A MINUTE, THEN ADD YOUR COLOR POPS WITH WATERCOLOR.

HOW TO BUILD A SKETCH FROM THE

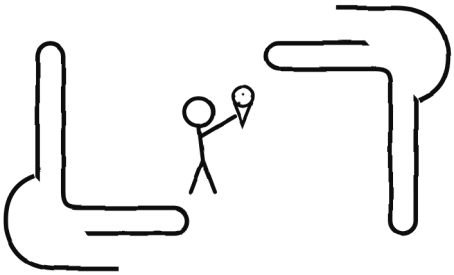
CENTER OUT

DON'T DRAW THE WHOLE PARK! FIND THE **ONE THING THAT'S HAPPENING**, DRAW IT BIG IN THE MIDDLE OF YOUR PAGE, THEN LET THE WORLD GROW OUT AROUND IT.

STORY MOMENT HUNT!

LOOK AROUND FOR ONE OF THESE... (OR FIND YOUR OWN)

- SOMEONE WAITING
- SOMEONE WORKING
- SOMEONE SELLING
- A DOG ON A MISSION
- SOMETHING BEING MADE
- ABOUT TO HAPPEN...
- TWO PEOPLE TALKING
- A KID + A SNACK

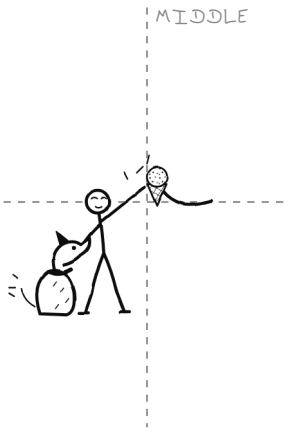


FRAME IT WITH YOUR FINGERS

SIZE CHECK: YOUR STORY MOMENT SHOULD BE ABOUT THE SIZE OF YOUR **FIST** ON THE PAGE. SMALLER THAN THAT? **START OVER BIGGER.**

1ST THE STORY MOMENT.

BIG, IN THE MIDDLE. THICK LINES.



2ND BIG SHAPES.

WHAT'S TOUCHING IT? ADD THAT NEXT.



3RD THE SETTING.

THIN LINES GOING OUT. EDGES FADE.



4TH POPS + NOTES.

2-3 COLORS, TINY TEXT, SIGN IT!



NOTICE HOW STEP 1 HAS NOTHING ELSE YET. THAT'S ON PURPOSE. GET THE MOMENT RIGHT AND THE REST IS EASY.

YOUR TIME:

LOOK 3 MIN · INK 20 MIN
COLOR 10 MIN · NOTES 2 MIN

HOW IT'S GRADED (8 PTS · 2 = YES · 1 = PARTLY · 0 = MISSING)

- ☐ **STORY MOMENT:** ONE CLEAR SUBJECT, BIG, NEAR THE MIDDLE.
- ☐ **CENTER OUT:** A SETTING BUILT AROUND IT, EDGES FADE.
- ☐ **INK:** PEN ONLY, THICK CLOSE + THIN FAR, GESTURE PEOPLE.
- ☐ **FINISH:** 2-3 COLOR POPS, NOTES OR TINY TEXT, SIGNED.